KENGANSOCIAL · MIRAISTACK · LAUNCH FORECAST

South Africa: launch on 30 November, first three months

How many South African customers KenganSocial can reach, how they split across the plans, and the profit month by month from December 2026 to February 2027 in three scenarios. Costs per month come from the capacity model (servers sized for that month's users, AI, voice, music, storage, Payfast, fixed costs) plus marketing.

CONSERVATIVE

138 paying

3 172 accounts by 28 Feb · MRR R103 662

3-month profit **−R41 548**

First profitable month: February 2027.
Launch costs paid back: after February.

BASE

499 paying

7 786 accounts by 28 Feb · MRR R381 501

3-month profit **R106 199**

First profitable month: January 2027.
Launch costs paid back: February 2027.

OPTIMISTIC

1 926 paying

20 185 accounts by 28 Feb · MRR R1 462 075

3-month profit **R904 587**

First profitable month: January 2027.
Launch costs paid back: January 2027.

In short: the base case (paid ads, a handful of creator partnerships, R35 000 a month on marketing) reaches about 499 paying customers and R381 501 in monthly subscriptions by the end of February, turns a monthly profit in January despite the festive shutdown, and has paid back its launch costs by February. Trial clip projects are now limited to 30-minute videos (changed 24 October); with the old 2-hour trial limit the base 3-month profit would be R42 765. Salaries are not included.

1. How big is the South African market?

SEGMENT	SERVICEABLE CUSTOMERS	PLANS THEY BUY	REALISTIC 3-YEAR SHARE	CUSTOMERS
Creators, podcasters, streamers	150 000	Free, Creator Starter, Creator Pro	2%	3 000
Small businesses that market on social	540 000	Free, Creator Starter, Creator Pro	1%	5 400
Agencies and social media managers	10 850	Creator Pro, Agency, Enterprise	4%	434
Total	**700 850**			**8 834**

- **Small businesses:** about 2 700 000 SMMEs, roughly a third formal (SEDA, Absa Small Business Growth Index 2025). We count the 60% of formal businesses assumed to market on social media.
- **Creators:** one South African creator network alone counts over 500 000 creators (theSalt); we count the 30% assumed to post weekly and want to grow or earn.
- **Agencies:** 31 000–37 000 registered advertising and marketing firms (CIPC data via CompanyData and InfobelPRO); we count the 35% assumed to run clients' social media.
- **Audience:** almost 41 million South Africans are active on social media (Ornico / World Wide Worx 2026), so the people these customers market to are there.

> The serviceable market is about 700 850 potential customers. Even the optimistic scenario ends February with 0.27% of it paying, so the forecast is limited by marketing reach and conversion, not by market size. Long-term, a 8 834-customer base at today's plan mix is the 3-year ceiling these shares imply.

2. How the launch is simulated

ASSUMPTION	CONSERVATIVE	BASE	OPTIMISTIC
What happens	Organic only: founders' networks, posts, a few creator shout-outs. R10 000/month marketing.	Paid social ads, 5–10 local creator partnerships, launch PR. R35 000/month marketing.	Strong ads, a viral creator moment, agency outreach. R90 000/month marketing.
Sign-ups a month before seasonality	900	2 000	4 500
Growth per month (word of mouth)	25%	35%	50%
Trial → paid (7-day trial, no card)	4%	6%	9%
Free → paid per month	1.5%	2%	3%
Enterprise deals (Dec / Jan / Feb)	0 / 0 / 0	0 / 0 / 1	0 / 1 / 2
Marketing per month	R10 000	R35 000	R90 000

- **Festive season:** sign-ups at 75% in December, 85% in January, 110% in February of a normal month. Many businesses close from mid-December to mid-January; creators keep posting, which softens the dip.
- **Everyone starts with the 7-day trial.** Those who don't buy drop to the Free plan; 50% of free accounts stay active and some upgrade later.
- **New paying customers split** 58% Creator Starter, 32% Creator Pro, 10% Agency; 6% of paying customers cancel each month; customers use 35% of their allowances.
- **Benchmarks:** no-card trials convert 4–6% (good) to 9% (strong); self-serve freemium 3–8% overall. Prices are the current monthly list prices (R299, R699, R3 499, R8 999 incl. VAT).
- **Pre-launch spend in November:** Launch video, brand and creator seeding R15 000; Legal review of Terms and Privacy Policy R8 000; Information Officer registration and admin R1 000.

3. Month by month

Conservative

MONTH	SIGN-UPS	PAYING STARTER / PRO / AGENCY / ENT.	ACCOUNTS FREE + PAYING	MRR INCL. VAT	REVENUE EX VAT	RUNNING COSTS	MARKETING	PROFIT	CUMULATIVE AFTER PRE-LAUNCH
December 2026	675	27 16 / 9 / 3 / 0	675	R21 572	R18 758	R33 058	R10 000	−R24 300	−R48 300
January 2027	956	68 40 / 22 / 7 / 0	1 629	R51 831	R45 070	R43 747	R10 000	−R8 677	−R56 977
February 2027	1 547	138 80 / 44 / 14 / 0	3 172	R103 662	R90 141	R64 711	R10 000	R15 430	−R41 548
3 months	**3 178**	**138**	**3 172**	**R103 662**	**R153 970**	**R195 517 incl. pre-launch**			**−R41 548**

Base

MONTH	SIGN-UPS	PAYING STARTER / PRO / AGENCY / ENT.	ACCOUNTS FREE + PAYING	MRR INCL. VAT	REVENUE EX VAT	RUNNING COSTS	MARKETING	PROFIT	CUMULATIVE AFTER PRE-LAUNCH
December 2026	1 500	90 52 / 29 / 9 / 0	1 500	R67 310	R58 530	R58 679	R35 000	−R35 148	−R59 148
January 2027	2 295	236 137 / 76 / 24 / 0	3 790	R178 063	R154 837	R90 992	R35 000	R28 845	−R30 303
February 2027	4 010	499 289 / 159 / 50 / 1	7 786	R381 501	R331 740	R160 238	R35 000	R136 502	R106 199
3 months	**7 805**	**499**	**7 786**	**R381 501**	**R545 108**	**R438 909 incl. pre-launch**			**R106 199**

Optimistic

MONTH	SIGN-UPS	PAYING STARTER / PRO / AGENCY / ENT.	ACCOUNTS FREE + PAYING	MRR INCL. VAT	REVENUE EX VAT	RUNNING COSTS	MARKETING	PROFIT	CUMULATIVE AFTER PRE-LAUNCH
December 2026	3 375	304 176 / 97 / 30 / 0	3 375	R225 397	R195 997	R123 726	R90 000	−R17 728	−R41 728
January 2027	5 738	849 492 / 271 / 85 / 1	9 096	R642 951	R559 088	R233 977	R90 000	R235 110	R193 382
February 2027	11 138	1 926 1115 / 615 / 192 / 3	20 185	R1 462 075	R1 271 370	R470 164	R90 000	R711 205	R904 587
3 months	**20 251**	**1 926**	**20 185**	**R1 462 075**	**R2 026 455**	**R1 121 867 incl. pre-launch**			**R904 587**

> **Running costs** include Payfast fees, AI, voice, music, transcription, storage, Firestore, the worker fleet and API server, hosting, backups, licences and the provider minimum plans. **MRR** is monthly subscriptions at list price including VAT; revenue is after VAT.

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4. Customers on each plan by 28 February

SCENARIO	FREE (ACTIVE + INACTIVE)	CREATOR STARTER	CREATOR PRO	AGENCY	ENTERPRISE	ALL ACCOUNTS	PAYING SHARE OF MARKET
Conservative	3 034	80	44	14	0	3 172	0.02%
Base	7 287	289	159	50	1	7 786	0.07%
Optimistic	18 259	1 115	615	192	3	20 185	0.27%

5. Where the money goes: base case, February

Payfast fees	R15 187
AI credits	R37 953
Clip AI (transcript ranking)	R7 140
Voice, music, render licence	R19 988
Post delivery (egress)	R11 782
Storage (GB-month + download)	R13 129
Firestore and sync	R37 391
Worker VMs (autoscaled)	R8 947
API VM (with Redis, Caddy)	R2 450
Web hosting	R350
Remotion licence minimum ($100, render fees count towards it)	R2 012
Backups, snapshots, domain, email, monitoring	R600
Provider minimum plans	R3 308
Marketing	R35 000
Total cost	**R195 238**
Revenue (ex VAT)	R331 740
Profit	**R136 502**

6. What this means

- **Marketing drives everything.** Organic-only (conservative) loses about R41 548 over the three months and reaches only 138 paying customers. Spending R35 000 a month (base) is profitable from January.
- **December will lose money in every scenario** (launch costs plus the festive slowdown). Plan cash for about R59 148 before revenue catches up.
- **Trial clip projects are limited (done).** Since 24 October a trial turns videos of up to 30 minutes into clips with the fast speech model, like Creator Starter, instead of Agency's 2 hours. With the old limit the 3-month result would have been −R59 687 (conservative), R42 765 (base), R733 732 (optimistic), and clip work at the busiest hour about five times higher.
- **The servers must scale before launch.** At the busiest hour in December the base case already sends 2.1× more render work and 2× more clip work than today's one-at-a-time queues can finish (16× with the old 2-hour trial). The worker pool in the readiness report (`docs/capacity/KenganSocial_1000_Users_Readiness.pdf`) is a launch requirement, not a later improvement. By February the base case needs about 20 workers at peak (already included in the costs above).
- **Agency customers carry the profit.** In the base case Agency is ~10% of new paying customers but about 46% of February's MRR. Direct outreach to agencies is the highest-value marketing.
- **Not included:** salaries and contractors, office costs, income tax, annual-plan cash paid upfront (it would improve cash flow), and any price changes. Exchange rate R17.50/US$.

Launch timeline

WHEN	WHAT
1–15 November	Worker pool and Cloud Storage live; trial clip limit; Payfast live tested; Meta, TikTok and YouTube approvals submitted; staging load test (readiness report checklist).
16–29 November	Creator partners signed and briefed; launch video and ads ready; agency outreach list; support inbox staffed.
30 November	Launch. Watch queue wait times, sign-ups, trial conversions and AI/voice/music spend daily.
December	Lean into creators (festive content), keep ads running at a lower budget during the shutdown weeks.
January	Back-to-work campaign from the second week; agency outreach; first annual-plan offer.
February	Scale what converted; review churn and plan mix; update this forecast with real numbers.

7. Sources

- Social media users: The Citizen, citing Ornico / World Wide Worx 2026
- SMMEs: Absa Small Business Growth Index 2025; Business Report, citing SEDA
- Creators: theSalt: half a million creators
- Agencies: CompanyData; InfobelPRO
- Conversion benchmarks: CrazyEgg; Userpilot
- Festive shutdown: BusinessTech; Yoco seasonal spend report

- Costs: `scripts/capacity-model.mjs` and `scripts/pricing-model.mjs`. Re-run with `node scripts/launch-forecast.mjs` and `node scripts/build-forecast-doc.mjs`.

KenganSocial is operated by MiraiStack (registration K2025971590). A forecast built on stated assumptions and public estimates, not a promise of results; update it with real sign-up and conversion data after launch.